What It Takes to Become a Westminster Dog Show Champion

成为威斯敏斯特狗展冠军需要什么

| Photography by Kenyon Anderson for WSJ. Magazine

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The elite athlete is capable of tremendous discipline. At the moment, though, he’s humping the competition.

Sonny, the star Portuguese water dog, went nosing around for a girlfriend when he was supposed to be attending to press obligations in the Long Island living room of his professional dog-show handler, Kimberly Calvacca. But there is much work to be done: In just a few days, Calvacca will load the freshly fluffed Sonny and five other crème-de-la-crème canines into a van and head to Manhattan to compete at the country’s biggest dog-sporting event: the Westminster Kennel Club Dog Show.

The pedigreed dogs are the epitome of their breeds, owned by enthusiasts who pay Calvacca $150 per show day for her more than 100 dog shows each year. The circuit reaches divine heights Tuesday in Madison Square Garden with Westminster’s top award of best in show, a status symbol that has eluded Calvacca, a third-generation dog handler in her 50s who started showing dogs in high school.

Her show dogs to date, and her grandfather’s in the past, have earned many prizes at Westminster, including best-in-breed and best-in-group, along with scores of awards elsewhere. Her home is full of silver bowls and ribbons in every color.

A portrait of her with a champion, Vera, a retired miniature pinscher or “min pin” who is now Calvacca’s pet, hangs over the fireplace.

The dogs live in her house, and some sleep on the bed she shares with her retired lawyer husband, Tony Calvacca.

Competing alongside Sonny are Valentina, a min pin and the only contender Calvacca partly owns; Tango, a pug; Estee, a canaan; Shindig, a vizsla; and Nala, a rambunctious toller who reacted to getting kicked out of this photo shoot by peeing on the floor.

When it’s showtime, the dogs perform. “It’s a lot of time, a lot of effort and making sure that this dog is raised right so it has the temperament to say, ‘Pick me!’” Calvacca says.

She trains them to stand stock-still when a judge inspects them nose to tail, or trot in a circle without getting distracted by the crowd. At times, she recreates show conditions at home so her pageant queens and kings won’t be spooked by whatever the competition throws at them.

| 摄影：Kenyon Anderson，为《华尔街日报》杂志供稿

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这位精英运动员拥有惊人的纪律性。然而，此刻，他正在“骚扰”竞争对手。

明星葡萄牙水犬桑尼（Sonny）本应在专业训犬师金伯利·卡尔瓦卡（Kimberly Calvacca）位于长岛的客厅里履行媒体义务，但他却四处嗅探寻找“女朋友”。不过，还有很多工作要做：几天后，卡尔瓦卡将把刚刚梳理蓬松的桑尼和另外五只顶尖犬只装进一辆货车，前往曼哈顿参加美国最大的犬类运动赛事：威斯敏斯特养犬俱乐部狗展。

这些纯种狗是其品种的典范，由爱好者拥有，他们每年为卡尔瓦卡参加的100多场狗展支付每天150美元的费用。这项赛事在周二于麦迪逊广场花园达到巅峰，颁发威斯敏斯特的最高奖项“全场总冠军”，这个奖项一直未能被卡尔瓦卡获得，她是一位50多岁的第三代训犬师，高中时就开始展示狗。

迄今为止，她的参赛犬以及她祖父过去的参赛犬，在威斯敏斯特赢得了许多奖项，包括“最佳犬种”和“最佳犬组”，以及其他地方的无数奖项。她的家里摆满了各种颜色的银碗和缎带。

一幅她与冠军犬薇拉（Vera）的肖像挂在壁炉上方，薇拉是一只已退役的迷你杜宾犬，现在是卡尔瓦卡的宠物。

狗儿们住在她家里，有些睡在她与退休律师丈夫托尼·卡尔瓦卡（Tony Calvacca）共用的床上。

与桑尼一同参赛的还有：瓦伦蒂娜（Valentina），一只迷你杜宾犬，也是卡尔瓦卡部分拥有的唯一参赛犬；探戈（Tango），一只哈巴狗；埃斯特（Estee），一只迦南犬；辛迪格（Shindig），一只维兹拉犬；以及娜拉（Nala），一只活泼好动的托勒犬，它因被赶出这次拍照而撒尿在地板上。

到了表演时间，狗儿们就会表现。“这需要大量的时间、大量的努力，并确保这只狗得到正确的饲养，使其拥有能说‘选我！’的性情。”卡尔瓦卡说。

她训练它们在评委从头到尾检查时一动不动地站立，或者在不被人群分散注意力的情况下小跑成圈。有时，她会在家里重现比赛条件，这样她的“选美皇后”和“国王”就不会被比赛中出现的任何情况吓到。

Most preshow work happens in her “dog room,” a basement utility space where pet scrubs and tinctures abound like makeup at Sephora. She says the room is filled with the good juju of champions her grandfather groomed there when this was his house.

大部分赛前准备工作都在她的“狗房”里进行，这是一个地下室杂物间，里面宠物洗护用品和酊剂像丝芙兰的化妆品一样琳琅满目。她说，这个房间里充满了她祖父当年在这里为冠军犬梳理毛发时留下的好运。

On her boombox, when Sade’s “Smooth Operator” switches to Britney Spears’s “Toxic,” the frantic synth reflects the chaos. First, she must wash the dogs one by one in an elevated bathtub. Then she hoists each dog onto a work table, attaching the animal loosely to a loop she cheerfully calls a noose. She trims their toenails with a repurposed woodworking tool, styles their fur with a $600 dog blow dryer and clips their coats with $1,000 scissors. She cleans their teeth with an electric toothbrush, a dental tool for plaque and a breath-freshener spray.

在她的手提音响里，当莎黛的《Smooth Operator》切换到布兰妮·斯皮尔斯的《Toxic》时，狂乱的合成器音乐反映出混乱。首先，她必须在一个高架浴缸里逐一清洗狗。然后她将每只狗抬到工作台上，用一个她愉快地称之为“套索”的环松散地系住它们。她用一个改装的木工工具修剪它们的脚趾甲，用一个600美元的狗用吹风机造型它们的毛发，并用1000美元的剪刀修剪它们的被毛。她用电动牙刷、牙菌斑清洁工具和口气清新喷雾清洁它们的牙齿。

Each dog spends 15 to 30 minutes daily on treadmills, one of which costs $3,500 and is specifically for dogs. Then come meals from 40-pound bags of dog food—she’s sponsored by Purina—and various biscuits and canned meats. In the ring, she gives them human treats such as salmon, steak and meatballs. On a recent day, she heaved a 10-pound bag of frozen chicken from Costco onto her kitchen counter, then boiled breasts with onion powder and garlic powder. She calls it her “winning chicken,” and during shows she’ll sometimes store a chunk of it between her teeth for quick access.

每只狗每天在跑步机上花费15到30分钟，其中一台跑步机价值3500美元，专为狗设计。然后是来自40磅狗粮袋的餐食——她由普瑞纳（Purina）赞助——以及各种饼干和罐头肉。在赛场上，她会给它们人类零食，如三文鱼、牛排和肉丸。最近的一天，她把一袋10磅重的开市客（Costco）冷冻鸡肉搬到厨房台面上，然后用洋葱粉和大蒜粉煮鸡胸肉。她称之为她的“冠军鸡肉”，在比赛期间，她有时会把一块鸡肉含在牙齿之间，以便快速取用。

Calvacca doesn’t play favorites, she says, but she snuggles Valentina and calls Sonny Mister Handsome. He is the exuberant frat boy, the alpha of the group. He licks, he yodels, he sleeps on a purple pillow. He plays it up in the ring. “Sonny always thinks he wins,” Calvacca says.

卡尔瓦卡说她不偏爱任何一只狗，但她会拥抱瓦伦蒂娜，并称桑尼为“帅哥先生”。他是那个精力充沛的“兄弟会男孩”，是群体中的阿尔法。他舔人，他约德尔（一种唱歌方式），他睡在紫色的枕头上。他在赛场上表现得非常出色。“桑尼总是认为自己会赢，”卡尔瓦卡说。

In a bedroom near pictures of her champions, Calvacca has laid out two St. John tweed skirtsuits, one pink and one purple, both with metallic-thread accents.

在一间靠近她冠军犬照片的卧室里，卡尔瓦卡摆放了两套圣约翰（St. John）粗花呢裙装，一套粉色，一套紫色，两套都带有金属线点缀。

The $2,000 suits were on sale, plus she always buys a new outfit for Westminster. She, too, must present well, she says, adding that she’s not like those who act bitter in front of judges when they don’t get first.

她说，这些2000美元的套装当时正在打折，而且她总是为威斯敏斯特比赛购买新服装。她补充说，她自己也必须表现得体，不像那些在评委面前因没有获得第一名而表现出不满的人。

Still, reaching Westminster’s best-in-show ring is the reason for it all.

然而，进入威斯敏斯特的“全场总冠军”决赛圈才是这一切的意义所在。

“That’s everybody’s dream.”

“那是每个人的梦想。”

Video Production by Mia Hariz, Nora Ballard; Produced by Rhyne Newton, Victoria Rosselli

视频制作：Mia Hariz, Nora Ballard；制作人：Rhyne Newton, Victoria Rosselli

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艾伦·加默曼（Ellen Gamerman）是《华尔街日报》时尚版和《华尔街日报》杂志的艺术文化记者。

She came to the Journal in 2005 and since then has covered a variety of beats, from family and relationships to theater and fine art. She won a Deadline Club award for a series on conflicts in the museum world. Before the Journal, Ellen worked as a national correspondent in Washington for the Baltimore Sun.

她于2005年加入《华尔街日报》，此后报道了各种领域，从家庭和人际关系到戏剧和美术。她因一系列关于博物馆界冲突的报道而获得了“截止日期俱乐部”奖。在加入《华尔街日报》之前，艾伦曾担任《巴尔的摩太阳报》驻华盛顿的全国记者。

TOEIC Vocabulary Study
托业词汇学习

1. tremendous
/trɪˈmɛndəs/

EN: very great in amount, scale, or intensity.

巨大的；极大的；惊人的

"The elite athlete is capable of tremendous discipline."

"这位精英运动员拥有惊人的纪律性。"

2. obligations
/ˌɒblɪˈɡeɪʃənz/

EN: a duty or commitment; the condition of being morally or legally bound to do something.

义务；职责；责任

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"明星葡萄牙水犬桑尼（Sonny）本应在专业训犬师金伯利·卡尔瓦卡（Kimberly Calvacca）位于长岛的客厅里履行媒体义务，但他却四处嗅探寻找“女朋友”。"

3. pedigreed
/ˈpɛdɪɡriːd/

EN: (of an animal) having a distinguished ancestry; purebred.

有血统证书的；纯种的

"The pedigreed dogs are the epitome of their breeds, owned by enthusiasts who pay Calvacca $150 per show day for her more than 100 dog shows each year."

"这些纯种狗是其品种的典范，由爱好者拥有，他们每年为卡尔瓦卡参加的100多场狗展支付每天150美元的费用。"

4. epitome
/ɪˈpɪtəmi/

EN: a person or thing that is a perfect example of a particular quality or type.

典范；缩影；完美榜样

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5. eluded
/ɪˈluːdɪd/

EN: (of an achievement or something desired) fail to be attained by (someone).

逃避；避开；（成功、理解等）未获得

"The circuit reaches divine heights Tuesday in Madison Square Garden with Westminster's top award of best in show, a status symbol that has eluded Calvacca, a third-generation dog handler in her 50s who started showing dogs in high school."

"这项赛事在周二于麦迪逊广场花园达到巅峰，颁发威斯敏斯特的最高奖项“全场总冠军”，这个奖项一直未能被卡尔瓦卡获得，她是一位50多岁的第三代训犬师，高中时就开始展示狗。"

6. contender
/kənˈtɛndər/

EN: a person or group competing with others to achieve something.

竞争者；争夺者

"Competing alongside Sonny are Valentina, a min pin and the only contender Calvacca partly owns."

"与桑尼一同参赛的还有：瓦伦蒂娜（Valentina），一只迷你杜宾犬，也是卡尔瓦卡部分拥有的唯一参赛犬。"

7. temperament
/ˈtɛmpərəmənt/

EN: a person's or animal's nature, especially as it permanently affects their behavior.

性情；气质；性格

"“It's a lot of time, a lot of effort and making sure that this dog is raised right so it has the temperament to say, 'Pick me!'" Calvacca says."

"“这需要大量的时间、大量的努力，并确保这只狗得到正确的饲养，使其拥有能说‘选我！’的性情。”卡尔瓦卡说。"

8. abound
/əˈbaʊnd/

EN: exist in large numbers or amounts; be plentiful.

大量存在；盛产；充满

"Most preshow work happens in her “dog room,” a basement utility space where pet scrubs and tinctures abound like makeup at Sephora."

"大部分赛前准备工作都在她的“狗房”里进行，这是一个地下室杂物间，里面宠物洗护用品和酊剂像丝芙兰的化妆品一样琳琅满目。"

9. repurposed

/ˌriːˈpɜːrpəst/

EN: adapted for use in a different way.

重新利用的；改作他用的

"She trims their toenails with a repurposed woodworking tool."

"她用一个改装的木工工具修剪它们的脚趾甲。"

10. exuberant

/ɪgˈzuːbərənt/

EN: full of energy, excitement, and cheerfulness.

热情洋溢的；精力充沛的；兴高采烈的

"He is the exuberant frat boy, the alpha of the group."

"他是那个精力充沛的“兄弟会男孩”，是群体中的阿尔法。"